

DOCUMENT 03

Shoot Mode Guide

Your on-set playbook — step-by-step lighting execution.

What is Shoot Mode?

Shoot Mode transforms an NGW recommendation into an ordered, role-aware list of on-set instructions. Instead of reading a gear list and figuring out placement yourself, Shoot Mode tells you exactly where to stand each light, at what height, what angle, and what power — and then walks you through your first test exposure.

Three Role Views

- Photographer — Full sequence: camera setup light placement test exposure adjustments.
- Assistant — Light-placement steps only. No camera settings.
- Second Shooter — Camera setup and test exposure only. No light placement.

Pre-Shoot Setup

Before launching Shoot Mode, confirm these inputs are correct. Errors here propagate through every step.

REQUIRED BEFORE LAUNCH

- My Kit is up to date — add any new gear; remove anything unavailable today.
- Ceiling height is set in Settings — Shoot Mode warns if a light position exceeds it.
- Room dimensions are entered — enables wall-proximity and bounce guidance.
- Reference analysis is complete — Shoot Mode requires an active recommendation.

Optional Inputs

- Master Mode — Select a photographer reference (e.g., Avedon, Penn, Lindbergh) to bias tone suggestions.
- Session Label — Name the session for future reference and outcome tracking.
- Estimated Duration — Helps NGW weight urgency in step ordering.

The Shoot Mode Workflow

1 Camera Setup

1 NGW gives aperture, ISO, shutter speed starting points matched to the pattern.

2 Place Key Light

2 Position the primary source at exact angle, height, and distance. Wall-proximity notes included.

3 Place Fill Light

3 Add fill or reflector. Shoot Mode specifies camera-side placement and fill ratio.

4 Add Accent Lights

4 Background, hair, rim, and kicker lights added in order of priority.

5 Set Power Levels

5 Starting power suggestions for each source, referenced to f/8 at key.

6 Take a Test Shot

6 Checklist of what to look for: catch-lights, shadow direction, fill ratio on the face.

7 Evaluate & Adjust

7 NGW compares your test shot result against the pattern and suggests corrections.

Step Detail — Light Placement

Each light-placement step includes all measurements in your preferred unit system. Distance is given in feet, meters, arm-lengths, and walking steps simultaneously for fieldwork without a tape measure.

Field	Example Value	Usage
Angle	45° camera-right	Stand in front of subject; count 45° off-center
Height	7.5 ft (arms + 1 step up)	Top of stand; flag if above ceiling
Distance	6 ft / 1.8 m / ~4 steps	Subject to light source front element
Wall proximity	3.2 ft from left wall	Bounce and spill warning zone
Modifier	Octa 90cm + diffusion sock	Attach before powering on
Power hint	Start at 1/4 power (~f/8)	Full-stop guide only — meter to confirm

Test Shot Evaluation

After your test shot, NGW can analyze the image and compare it to the target pattern. Upload the test shot via the evaluate button in Shoot Mode.

What NGW Checks

- Catch-light position — matches expected angle for the pattern.
- Shadow direction — loop vs. Rembrandt vs. butterfly shadow fall.
- Fill ratio — side of face in shadow vs. fill, compared to target.
- Background separation — key vs. background ratio estimate.
- Specular highlights — modifier signature matches (harsh vs. soft).

FIELD NOTE

- If your ceiling is below 9 ft, Shoot Mode will warn on any step that requires a boom arm above ceiling height. It will automatically suggest floor-level or camera-mounted alternatives.